



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 38

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Housekeeping as a Safety Practice

OVERVIEW:

Housekeeping is not a cleanliness preference — it is an active injury prevention activity. Trip hazards, fire hazards, respiratory hazards, and struck-by hazards are all directly created and managed by the cleanliness of the work environment. A crew that maintains a clean, organized work area has

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Trip hazards are the most common housekeeping-related injury cause in finish carpentry. Extension cords strung across floor traffic areas, cut-offs scattered around the saw, scraps left where they were trimmed, and packaging material from deliveries all become trip hazards the moment they hit the floor. The standard is simple: if you create it, you address it immediately. Cut-offs go in the
2. Extension cord management is worth specific attention because it involves a hazard that recreates itself every time a cord is used and dropped. Cords should be run along walls and baseboards where possible, elevated off the floor with hooks or cord bridges in traffic areas, and coiled and stored when not in active use. A cord stretched across a doorway or aisle in a busy job will eventually
3. Tools left on elevated surfaces — scaffold platforms, ladder shelves, window sills, the top of cabinets — become dropped-object hazards for workers below. A hammer or drill falling 8 feet generates enough force to cause a fatal head injury. Every tool that goes up must come down on purpose, in hand, not by gravity. At the end of every shift, walk your work area and confirm that
4. A clean job site also communicates professionalism to the customer. On occupied or partially occupied buildings, a cluttered, dusty work area is not just a safety hazard — it reflects on Allegheny Millwork and affects our relationship with the client. Take pride in leaving every work area cleaner at the end of the day than it was at the start. Your safety and our reputation are

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Walk through our current work area right now and identify the top three housekeeping hazards.
Q2: What is our cleanup procedure at the end of each shift on this project?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Clear cut-offs and scraps from the floor continuously throughout every shift
- Coil and store extension cords when not in use — they are a leading trip hazard
- Never leave tools on the floor or on scaffold edges where they can fall
- Dispose of all waste in designated bins — not in corners or behind equipment
- Mark any hazard you cannot immediately correct so all others are warned

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 38

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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